Hustle Hive CIC – Complaints Procedure

Item	Detail
Organisation	Hustle Hive CIC, company no. 16691281
Complaints lead	Kieron Davis, Director (07395 828429, kieron@hustlehive.co.uk)
Complaints about Kieron Davis	Gavin Copland, Director (07593 975681, gavin@hustlehive.co.uk)
Version	1.0
Effective from	October 2026
Next review	September 2027

1. Our commitment

We want everyone who uses Hustle Hive to have a good experience. If something goes wrong, we want to know so we can put it right and learn from it. We will listen, treat you with respect, deal with your complaint fairly and promptly, and keep it confidential. Making a complaint will never affect how we treat you or a young person in our care.

2. Who can complain

Anyone who uses or is affected by our services can complain, including learners, parents and carers, adults on our courses, commissioning schools and local authorities, and members of the public. Someone else, such as a relative or advocate, can complain on your behalf with your permission. Young people can complain themselves, and staff will help them do so.

3. What this procedure covers

This procedure covers complaints about our services, for example the quality of a session, how a learner was supported, communication, bookings and payments, or the conduct of our staff (unless it is a safeguarding matter).

Some concerns follow a different procedure:

Concern	Where it goes
A child may be at risk of harm	Our Designated Safeguarding Lead, Gavin Copland (07593 975681), straight away, or call 999 in an emergency. See our Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy
An adult working with children may have harmed a child or may pose a risk	Our Safeguarding policy (section 9), or the Darlington Designated Officer (LADO) on 01325 405319
How we have used your personal information	Kieron Davis, under our Data Protection Policy
A concern from a member of staff or volunteer about wrongdoing	Our Whistleblowing Policy
A staff member's own employment	Our grievance procedure
A school's decision about a placed learner	The commissioning school's own complaints procedure

Please raise a complaint as soon as possible, and normally within 3 months of the event. We may still look at older complaints if there is a good reason for the delay.

4. How to complain

Stage	What to do	What we will do	Timescale
1. Informal	Speak to the member of staff involved, or to Gavin Copland or Kieron Davis, in person, by phone or by email	Listen, try to put things right straight away, and note what was agreed	We aim to resolve it within 5 working days

Stage	What to do	What we will do	Timescale
2. Formal	If you are not happy with the outcome, or would rather go straight to a formal complaint, write to Kieron Davis by email, letter or using the form below	Acknowledge your complaint, look into it, speak to you and anyone else involved, and give you a written response explaining what we found, our decision and any action we will take	Acknowledged within 5 working days; full response within 20 working days
3. Review	If you are still unhappy, ask for a review within 20 working days of our Stage 2 response, saying why	The Director not involved in the complaint reviews how it was handled and the outcome, and may meet with you. If both Directors have been involved, we ask an independent person, such as our accountant or an experienced professional from another organisation, to carry out the review. Their decision is final	Response within 20 working days

If we need more time, for example during school holidays or when we need information from others, we will tell you why and give you a new date.

Complaints about a Director

If your complaint is about Kieron Davis, send it to Gavin Copland (07593 975681, gavin@hustlehive.co.uk). If it is about Gavin Copland, send it to Kieron Davis. The Director not involved deals with it at Stage 2, and any Stage 3 review is carried out by an independent person. No one will investigate a complaint about themselves.

What to include

Tell us what happened and when, who was involved, what you have already done to sort it out, and what you would like us to do. You can bring a friend or supporter to any meeting.

Possible outcomes

We may uphold your complaint in full or in part, or not uphold it. Where we got something wrong, we will apologise, explain what we will do to put it right, and, where appropriate, offer a refund, a replacement session or another remedy. We will also tell you what we have changed to stop it happening again.

5. If you are still unhappy

If you remain unhappy after Stage 3, you may be able to take your complaint further:

- **Learners placed by a school or local authority:** you can raise your concerns with the commissioning school or local authority, which keeps responsibility for the learner's education. We will co-operate fully with them, and we tell them about any formal complaint relating to their learner.
- **How we have handled your personal information:** the Information Commissioner's Office, at ico.org.uk or on 0303 123 1113.
- **Bookings, payments and refunds:** free consumer advice is available from Citizens Advice, on 0808 223 1133.
- **How our community interest company is run:** the Office of the Regulator of Community Interest Companies, on gov.uk.
- **Programmes paid for by a funder:** you can also contact the funder.

6. Fair handling

- **Confidentiality:** we only share details of your complaint with the people who need to know to deal with it. If your complaint raises a safeguarding concern, we will follow our Safeguarding policy, and may need to share information to protect a child.
- **Anonymous complaints:** we will look into these where we can, but we may not be able to investigate fully or respond.
- **Accessibility:** if you need help to make a complaint, for example because of a disability or language, tell us and we will make adjustments, such as taking your complaint by phone or in person.
- **Unreasonable behaviour:** we will not tolerate abusive, threatening or discriminatory behaviour towards our staff. If a complaint is repeated after it has been fully dealt with, or contact becomes unreasonable, a Director may limit how we communicate with you, and will explain why in writing. This does not stop us looking at any new issue you raise.

7. Records and learning

Kieron Davis keeps a confidential log of all formal complaints, their outcome and any actions taken. Complaint records are kept for 6 years after the complaint is closed, in line with our Records Retention Policy, and are kept separately from learner files. The Directors review all complaints every year to spot patterns and improve our services.

8. Review

This procedure is reviewed every year.

Related policies

Read this procedure alongside our Safeguarding and Child Protection, Whistleblowing, Data Protection, Equality, Diversity & Inclusion and Behaviour and Positive Conduct policies.

Approval and signatures

This procedure has been approved by the Board of Directors of Hustle Hive CIC.

Name	Position	Signature	Date
Gavin Copland	Director		
Kieron Davis	Director, complaints lead		
Carey Viala	Director		
Sarah Smith	Director		

Appendix: Complaint form

Send to Kieron Davis at kieron@hustlehive.co.uk, or hand it to a member of staff. If your complaint is about Kieron Davis, send it to Gavin Copland at gavin@hustlehive.co.uk.

Your name	
Contact details (phone, email, address)	
Your relationship to Hustle Hive (e.g. parent, learner, school, course participant)	

If complaining for someone else, their name and your relationship to them	
Programme or activity	
What happened, and when?	
Who was involved?	
What have you already done to sort this out?	
What would you like us to do to put things right?	
Signature and date	

Office use

Date received and by whom	
Date acknowledged	
Investigated by	
Outcome and date of response	
Review requested? Date and outcome	
Actions to prevent it happening again	